

**ECON 1B03: Introductory Microeconomics**

**Summer 2026**

**Instructor Information**

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Office hours: Posted on Avenue to Learn (A2L)

**Notice**

Please note that the terms and conditions contained in the course syllabus as listed below are not negotiable under any circumstances. Your continued enrollment in the course beyond the final registration date of Monday July 13, 2026 constitutes your explicit acceptance of all terms and conditions listed in this syllabus and your explicit agreement to abide by all such terms. Your continued enrollment in the course furthermore constitutes your explicit acceptance and agreement to abide by all university policies whether listed or not listed in this syllabus.

**Course Information**

Lectures: see Avenue to Learn (A2L) or MOSAIC for times and classroom information

Labs: No

Tutorials: No

Course Dates: 2026/06/29- 2026/08/14

Units: 3.0

Course Delivery Mode: Online

Course Description: An introduction to the method and theory of microeconomics, and their application to the analysis of contemporary economic problems.

Hours of Study: 3 hours per week.

## **Meeting Details**

The course is delivered using an online-learning format. Each week, you will complete a series of lessons provided on Avenue in video format at a time which is convenient for you. You will also have a series of readings from the course textbook to complete independently. You will also complete homework problems from the textbook.

Throughout the course, you will be asked to demonstrate your learning by completing regular homework, quizzes, activities, and exams. Please be sure to use a weekly schedule to stay on track with the assigned readings, videos, homework, and activities throughout the semester!

## **Important Links**

- [Mosaic](#)
- [Avenue to Learn](#)
- [Student Accessibility Services - Accommodations](#)
- [McMaster University Library](#)
- [eReserves](#)
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## **Course Learning Outcomes**

By the end of the course students should be able to:

- Explain the basic concepts of supply and demand and price determination.
- Explain the process by which consumers make decisions.
- Explain how firms make production and pricing decisions.
- Describe the features of competitive, oligopoly, and monopoly market structures.
- Explain the role of government in the economy and the effect of policy changes on market outcomes.

## **Materials and Fees**

- **Textbook (Required)**

Hubbard, G., O'Brien, A.P., Serletis, A., and Childs, J. (2024). *Microeconomics*, 4<sup>th</sup> Canadian Edition, Hoboken, NJ: Pearson Education.

**Students automatically receive an electronic copy of the textbook upon registration in the course through the Immediate Access Program. An electronic copy of the textbook, along with MyLab access (see below) is provided to students at a discounted price of \$102.95. The cost of the discounted Immediate Access textbook will be billed directly to your university account by the Campus Store after July 17 and you will see this charge on MOSAIC.**

Students will need to register their textbook using the Textbook Registration link on Avenue. After registering, you will be able to access an electronic copy of the textbook through the link provided on Avenue.

Students also have the option of purchasing an additional physical copy of the book through the link provided on Avenue if you would prefer a physical copy. Physical copies are available at extra charge.

Students who do not wish to participate in the Immediate Access program must complete the opt-out instructions issued to them by the Campus Store. You must opt out by July 17 or you will remain in the Immediate Access program and your account will be charged. Students who opt out will need to purchase their own copy of the textbook and MyLab access separately.

If you were registered in the course in either Fall 2025 or Winter 2026 and participated in the Immediate Access Program in that term and are re-enrolling in the Summer, your previous registration is still valid. Students who are re-enrolling from Fall 2025 or Winter 2026 SHOULD OPT-OUT and contact [optout@mcmaster.ca](mailto:optout@mcmaster.ca) for assistance in continuing your previous registration.

- **Pearson MyLab (Required)**

Please note that access to MyLab is included with the textbook for students participating in the Inclusive Access program (see above). Students who opt out of the Inclusive Access automatic textbook registration program and instead choose to purchase their own textbook separately will need to purchase a MyLab subscription as well.

- **Calculator (Required)**

A calculator is required for the course. Any scientific calculator model is acceptable.

- **Computer and Internet Connection (Required)**

A computer and working internet connection is required to complete the course.

- **Respondus Lockdown Browser (Required)**

The Respondus Lockdown Browser is required. The software is available for free from within Avenue. Students will be directed to the software when they load each quiz.

## **Course Evaluation**

1. Syllabus Quiz – 0%, Complete it as soon as possible
2. MyLab Homework – 10%, Weekly Due Dates (refer to schedule below)
3. Reflection Activities – 10%, Due in Week 4 and Week 7 (refer to schedule below)
4. Quizzes – 80%, Weekly Due Dates (refer to schedule below)

## **Course Evaluation Details**

### **Syllabus Quiz (0%)**

There is one Syllabus Quiz available on Avenue. The Syllabus Quiz contains 20 multiple choice questions about the contents of this course syllabus. Please be sure to read the complete syllabus thoroughly before completing the Syllabus Quiz. **You must score 100% on the Syllabus Quiz to unlock the lesson videos and lecture notes for the term.** You can attempt the Syllabus Quiz as many times as is necessary to obtain 100%.

### **MyLab Homework (10%)**

There are 12 assigned homework exercises to be completed in MyLab. Students can access MyLab using the Pearson link found on Avenue (it is the same link that opens the textbook).

**Each homework exercise is due on TUESDAY at 11:59PM** (Eastern Time) according to the following schedule.

Week 1 – *No Homework Due*  
Week 2 – Chapter 1, 2  
Week 3 – Chapter 3, 4  
Week 4 – Chapter 6, 8  
Week 5 – Chapter 9, 10  
Week 6 – Chapter 11, 12  
Week 7 – Chapter 13, 5 and 15

**Only the best 10 MyLab homework submission grades will count towards your final grade.** The two lowest grades from the 12 assignments will be excluded from the final grade calculation. Each assignment contributes a maximum of 1% towards your final grade. Please note that there are no extensions to the MyLab homework due dates under any circumstances. Please note that an MSAF will not provide any relief for missed MyLab homework.

Please note that you should open each assignment and submit at least one answer before the due date, even if you do not have time to complete the full homework assignment – the

way the system is set up (by the publisher, not by me), if you do not open an assignment before the due date, you cannot access it after the due date to study for the quizzes.

### **Reflection Activities (10%)**

There are two reflection activities to be completed by the beginning of Week 4 and Week 7 respectively. The reflection activities require you to write short reflections on experiences with microeconomic principles and phenomena. Details of the reflection activities are provided on Avenue. If you miss a reflection activity, you may complete an MSAF to receive an extension. Please note that extensions will not normally exceed three days. Refer to the MSAF section below for further information.

### **Quizzes (80%)**

There are six quizzes, beginning in Week 2 (see the schedule on pages 12 and 13).

Quiz #1 – Ch. 1, 2

Quiz #2 – Ch. 3, 4

Quiz #3 – Ch. 6, 8

Quiz #4 – Ch. 9, 10

Quiz #5 – Ch. 11, 12

Quiz #6 – Ch. 13, 5 and 15

Your lowest quiz score will be dropped. The remaining five quizzes will be worth 16% each.

The quizzes will consist of 20 multiple choice questions (worth one point each). There is a 35-minute time limit for each quiz. You may or may not see a “countdown clock” during the quiz, depending on your browser choice and/or computer settings. Because you are taking the quiz on your own, we cannot invigilate the same way that we invigilate in-person tests. This means that you can use your notes and textbook during the quiz. You are expected to complete this quiz without the aid of other students. **Quizzes will be held on Wednesdays and will be available from 7:00 pm EDT until 9:00 pm EDT.**

The quizzes require the use of Respondus Lockdown Browser. The Lockdown Browser prevents you from accessing other websites during the quiz. To access the Respondus Browser, go the Quizzes page on Avenue and start the quiz. You will be prompted to activate the Lockdown Browser before the quiz begins.

To ensure your success on the quizzes, please do the following:

- Close all other apps/programs/browser windows.
- Carefully read all instructions before beginning the quiz. The assigned time limit does not begin until you click "start quiz".

- You will see one question at a time, and you cannot move back and forth between questions.
- Once you have chosen your answer click "next question". Do **not** click "next question" more than once. Clicking more than once may result in the pop-up getting stuck and impeding your ability to read future questions. You will not be given any consideration should you make this mistake.
- When you have answered all questions, click "submit quiz". You must submit the quiz for it to be graded. Do **not** click "submit quiz" until you have answered all questions.
- If you miss the quiz, complete the online MSAF form. The rewrite will be on the Monday during the week following the missed quiz from 7:00 pm EDT to 9:00 pm EDT (i.e., 5 days after the original quiz date), except on Monday August 3 where the rewrite will instead take place on Tuesday August 4.
- In the rare event that you should experience a technical problem, exit the quiz, and relaunch it. The clock will continue to run. **If you begin a quiz, you cannot submit an MSAF for that quiz.**
- The “drop lowest score” policy is meant to be insurance against: (1) computer technical problems; (2) internet service provider issues; (3) you mistakenly submit the entire quiz after completing only a few questions; (4) any other event that causes you to have started, but not finished a quiz. If you miss a quiz completely, your first course of action should be to submit the MSAF and take the rewrite. If you rely on this “drop lowest score” policy for a missed quiz, and then later in the course you experience technical difficulties, or submission mistakes, you will **not** be given any special consideration.

Note that, although quizzes are not specifically cumulative, because later chapters require an understanding of earlier chapters, some knowledge applicable to earlier quizzes will also be applicable in later quizzes.

## **Grading Scale**

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| <b>Grade</b> | <b>Equivalent Grade Point</b> | <b>Equivalent Percentages</b> |
|--------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| A+           | 12                            | 90-100                        |
| A            | 11                            | 85-89.99                      |
| A-           | 10                            | 80-84.99                      |
| B+           | 9                             | 77-79.99                      |
| B            | 8                             | 73-76.99                      |
| B-           | 7                             | 70-72.99                      |
| C+           | 6                             | 67-69.99                      |
| C            | 5                             | 63-66.99                      |
| C-           | 4                             | 60-62.99                      |
| D+           | 3                             | 57-59.99                      |
| D            | 2                             | 53-56.99                      |
| D-           | 1                             | 50-52.99                      |
| F            | 0                             | 0-49.99                       |



## **Course Schedule**

### **Week 1 (June 29 – July 3)**

Unit 1: Introduction to Economics (Chapter 1, Chapter 1 Appendix)

Unit 2: Trade-Offs and Comparative Advantage (Chapter 2)

### **Week 2 (July 6 - 10)**

Unit 3: Supply and Demand (Chapter 3, Chapter 3 Appendix)

Unit 4: Efficiency (Chapter 4)

**MyLab Homework: Chapter 1, Chapter 2 DUE July 7**

**Quiz 1 DUE July 8**

### **Week 3 (July 13 - 17)**

Unit 5: Elasticity (Chapter 6)

Unit 6: Consumer Choice (Chapter 8)

**MyLab Homework: Chapter 3, Chapter 4 DUE July 14**

**Quiz 2 DUE July 15**

### **Week 4 (July 20 - 24)**

Unit 7: Production and Costs (Chapter 9, Chapter 9 Appendix)

Unit 8: Perfect Competition (Chapter 10)

**Reflection Activity 1 DUE July 20**

**MyLab Homework: Chapter 6, Chapter 8 DUE July 21**

**Quiz 3 DUE July 22**

**Week 5 (July 27 - 31)**

Unit 9: Monopolistic Competition (Chapter 11)

Unit 10: Oligopoly (Chapter 12)

**MyLab Homework: Chapter 9, Chapter 10 DUE July 28**

**Quiz 4 DUE July 29**

**Week 6 (August 4 - 7)**

Unit 11: Monopoly (Chapter 13)

Unit 12: Public Economics (Chapters 5 and 15)

**MyLab Homework: Chapter 11, Chapter 12 DUE August 4**

**Quiz 5 DUE August 5**

**Week 7 (August 10 - 14)**

No further unit lessons.

**Reflection Activity 2 DUE August 10**

**MyLab Homework Chapter 13, Chapters 5 and 15 DUE August 11**

**Quiz 6 DUE August 12**

## **Late Assignments**

Please note that late MyLab homework will not be accepted under any circumstances. Please make sure you complete the MyLab homework by the due date. If you miss the due date for the MyLab homework, you will receive a grade of zero for that assessment. Please keep in mind that you are allowed to miss up to two MyLab homework assignments without impacting your final grade. Late Reflection Activities will only be accepted if you have an approved MSAF.

## **Absences, Missed Work or Illness**

Students may submit a McMaster Student Absence Form (Self-Report) or a McMaster Student Absence Form (Administrative Report) and request relief from assessed work according to the following:

MSAF (Self Report) requests for relief are for missed academic work worth less than 25% of the final grade resulting from medical or personal situations lasting up to three (3) calendar days. Students shall use the MOSAIC MSAF tool to make MSAF (Self-Report) requests, which:

- a) may only be submitted once per term;
- b) must be submitted within 24 hours of the end of the three (3) day period, and failure to do so may negate the opportunity for relief;
- c) applies only to work due within the period for which the request applies, i.e., the three-day period specified in the MSAF; however, all work due in that period can be covered by one request; and
- d) where applicable, students must provide documentation proving they have not attempted the work if they submit a request for relief.

In the event that a student's MSAF (Self-Report) is accepted, the following relief will be provided:

- 1) MyLab Homework – There is no relief provided for missed MyLab homework.
- 2) Reflection Activity – You will receive a three day extension from the original due date.
- 3) Quiz – You will be allowed to write a deferred quiz on the Monday following the original quiz date, except for Monday August 3; a rewrite quiz that would otherwise be scheduled for Monday August 3 will be scheduled for Tuesday August 4. The deferred quiz will take place between 7:00PM EDT and 9:00PM EDT.

For absences that exceed three (3) calendar days, students must request a MSAF (Administrative Report). Students must contact their Faculty/Program Office to report their absence within 24 hours after returning to their academic activities. Failure to contact and report an absence promptly will negate the opportunity for relief. Students may or may not

require an appointment to process the request and will be contacted by the Faculty/Program Office within normal business hours. Where applicable, students must provide documentation proving they have not attempted the work if they submit a request for relief.

In the event that a student's MSAF (Administrative Report) is accepted, the following relief will be provided:

- 1) MyLab Homework – There is no relief provided for missed MyLab homework.
- 2) Reflection Activity – In the event that your absence ends less than three days after the original due date, you will receive a three day extension from the original due date. In the event that your absence ends more than three days after the original due date, your reflection will be due on the date you return to your studies.

Quiz – You will be allowed to write a deferred quiz on the Monday following your return to study, except for Monday August 3; a rewrite quiz that would otherwise be scheduled for Monday August 3 will be scheduled for Tuesday August 4. The deferred quiz will take place between 7:00PM EDT and 9:00PM EDT.

## **Turnitin.com**

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For students using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. A2L, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to [www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity](http://www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity).

## **Course Modification**

The instructor and university reserve the right to modify elements of the course during the term. The university may change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances. If either type of modification becomes necessary, reasonable notice and communication with the students will be given with an explanation and the opportunity to comment on changes. It is the responsibility of the student to check their McMaster email and course websites weekly during the term and to note any changes.

## **Generative AI**

### **Generative AI: Use Prohibited**

Students are not permitted to use generative AI in this course. In alignment with [McMaster academic integrity policy](#), it “shall be an offence knowingly to ... submit academic work for assessment that was purchased or acquired from another source”. This includes work created by generative AI tools. Also state in the policy is the following, “Contract Cheating is the act of “outsourcing of student work to third parties” (Lancaster & Clarke, 2016, p. 639) with or without payment.” Using Generative AI tools is a form of contract cheating. Charges of academic dishonesty will be brought forward to the Office of Academic Integrity.

## **APPROVED ADVISORY STATEMENTS**

### **Academic Integrity**

You are expected to exhibit honesty and use ethical behaviour in all aspects of the learning process. Academic credentials you earn are rooted in principles of honesty and academic integrity. **It is your responsibility to understand what constitutes academic dishonesty.**

Academic dishonesty is to knowingly act or fail to act in a way that results or could result in unearned academic credit or advantage. This behaviour can result in serious consequences, e.g. the grade of zero on an assignment, loss of credit with a notation on the transcript (notation reads: “Grade of F assigned for academic dishonesty”), and/or suspension or expulsion from the university. For information on the various types of academic dishonesty please refer to the [Academic Integrity Policy](#), located at <https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/>

The following illustrates only three forms of academic dishonesty:

- plagiarism, e.g. the submission of work that is not one’s own or for which other credit has been obtained.
- improper collaboration in group work.
- copying or using unauthorized aids in tests and examinations.

### **Authenticity / Plagiarism**

**Some courses may** use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. Avenue to Learn, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. **All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld** (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to [www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity](http://www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity).

### **Email Communication**

Effective September 1, 2010, it is the policy of the Faculty of Social Sciences that all e-mail communication sent from students to instructors (including Tasks), and from students to staff, must originate from the student's own McMaster University e-mail account. This policy protects confidentiality and confirms the identity of the student. It is the student's responsibility to ensure that communication is sent to the university from a McMaster account. If an instructor becomes aware that a communication has come from an alternate address, the instructor may not reply at his/her/their discretion.

### **Courses with an On-line Element**

**Some courses may** use on-line elements (e.g. e-mail, Avenue to Learn, LearnLink, web pages, capa, Moodle, ThinkingCap, etc.). Students should be aware that, when they access the electronic components of a course using these elements, private information such as first and last names, usernames for the McMaster e-mail accounts, and program affiliation may become apparent to all other students in the same course. The available information is dependent on the technology used. Continuation in a course that uses on-line elements will be deemed consent to this disclosure. If you have any questions or concerns about such disclosure, please discuss this with the course instructor.

### **Online Proctoring**

**Some courses may** use online proctoring software for tests and exams. This software may require students to turn on their video camera, present identification, monitor and record their computer activities, and/or lock/restrict their browser or other applications/software during tests or exams. This software may be required to be installed before the test/exam begins.

### **Conduct Expectations**

As a McMaster student, you have the right to experience, and the responsibility to demonstrate, respectful and dignified interactions within all of our living, learning and working communities. These expectations are described in the [Code of Student Rights & Responsibilities](#) (the "Code"). All students share the responsibility of maintaining a positive environment for the academic and personal growth of all McMaster community members, **whether in person or online.**

It is essential that students be mindful of their interactions online, as the Code remains in effect in virtual learning environments. The Code applies to any interactions that adversely affect, disrupt, or interfere with reasonable participation in University activities. Student disruptions or behaviours that interfere with university functions on online platforms (e.g. use of Avenue 2 Learn, WebEx or Zoom for delivery), will be taken very seriously and will be investigated. Outcomes may include restriction or removal of the involved students' access to these platforms.

### **Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities**

Students with disabilities who require academic accommodation must contact [Student Accessibility Services](#) (SAS) at 905-525-9140 ext. 28652 or [sas@mcmaster.ca](mailto:sas@mcmaster.ca) to make arrangements with a Program Coordinator. For further information, consult McMaster University's [Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities](#) policy.

### **Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work**

In the event of an absence for medical or other reasons, students should review and follow the [Policy on Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work](#).

### **Academic Accommodation for Religious, Indigenous, or Spiritual Observances (RISO)**

Students requiring academic accommodation based on religious, indigenous or spiritual observances should follow the procedures set out in the [RISO](#) policy. Students should submit their request to their Faculty Office **normally within 10 working days** of the beginning of term in which they anticipate a need for accommodation or to the Registrar's Office prior to their examinations. Students should also contact their instructors as soon as possible to make alternative arrangements for classes, assignments, and tests.

### **Copyright and Recording**

Students are advised that lectures, demonstrations, performances, and any other course material provided by an instructor include copyright protected works. The Copyright Act and copyright law protect every original literary, dramatic, musical and artistic work, **including lectures** by University instructors.

The recording of lectures, tutorials, or other methods of instruction may occur during a course. Recording may be done by either the instructor for the purpose of authorized distribution, or by a student for the purpose of personal study. Students should be aware that their voice and/or image may be recorded by others during the class. Please speak with the instructor if this is a concern for you.

**Extreme Circumstances**

The University reserves the right to change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances (e.g., severe weather, labour disruptions, etc.). Changes will be communicated through regular McMaster communication channels, such as McMaster Daily News, Avenue to Learn and/or McMaster email.